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With respect to the provisions of the Single Convention on Narcotic Drugs of 1961, as amended by the 1972 Protocol and the Convention on Psychotropic Substances of 1971, the International Narcotics Control Board (INCB) has the honour to draw your attention to the following matter.

Acknowledging the potential medical use of cannabis and its active components, INCB aims to work with governments to achieve greater uniformity in reporting and monitoring standards regarding the cultivation, manufacture, distribution, and global trade of cannabis and cannabis-derived products for medical and scientific purposes.

The international control framework for such use is established by the Single Convention on Narcotic Drugs of 1961, as amended by the 1972 Protocol, and the Convention on Psychotropic Substances of 1971, as well as relevant resolutions of the Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) and the Commission on Narcotic Drugs (CND). The provisions of the above-mentioned treaties are implemented within domestic legislation and regulation, permitting licensed activities and the use of narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances for medical and scientific purposes and their application is essential to enable appropriate monitoring by Competent National Authorities and INCB. This ensures that data on licensed activities, such as cultivation, and the production of controlled substances accurately reflect national estimates and assessments reported by Competent National Authorities to INCB.

The recent increase in activities related to the use of cannabis for medical purposes has challenged the ability of many Competent National Authorities to ensure compliance with international drug control requirements. INCB is therefore providing the following information to strengthen the capacity of Competent National Authorities and decision-makers to:

- a. Implement the requirements of the international drug control conventions as they relate to cannabis, cannabis-related substances, and derived products for medical and scientific purposes;
- b. Comply with the regulatory control and monitoring requirements for the licit trade in narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances, including cannabis-related activities at the national level, and participate in the international trade of cannabis, cannabis-related substances, and derived products;
- c. Meet reporting obligations in an accurate and timely manner.

The attached document aims to provide guidance on harmonizing the control, monitoring, and reporting practices for cannabis and related substances in accordance with the requirements of the Single Convention on Narcotic Drugs of 1961, as amended by the 1972 Protocol and the Convention on Psychotropic Substances of 1971, as well as in line with the decisions of CND, based on the recommendations of the World Health Organization (WHO) at its reconvened 63rd session on the scheduling of cannabis and cannabis-related substances.

This document also provides information on practical aspects of the control and reporting requirements of the relevant Conventions as they pertain to cannabis for medical and scientific purposes, including licensing, monitoring, and reporting, with a focus on cultivation, manufacturing yields, and accurately reporting quantities of controlled substances.

The Board urges States parties to ensure that the cultivation, production, utilization and consumption of cannabis, cannabis-related substances, and derived products for medical and scientific purposes in their territories is undertaken in line with the requirements outlined in the attached document and is not used for purposes other than those explicitly indicated in the Single Convention on Narcotic Drugs of 1961, as amended by the 1972 Protocol, and the Convention on Psychotropic Substances of 1971.

The Board trusts that your Government will give due attention to these considerations.

Vienna, 16 December 2024

